

READY TO RANK × TACTICAL TRADIE GROUP

How tradies get **found** in 2026.

Google, Maps and AI have quietly changed how customers pick a trade. Here's what's happening — and how to be the one they call.

PREPARED FOR THE TACTICAL TRADIE GROUP

THE BIG QUESTION

What is GEO?

👉 Any guesses? Shout it out.

By the end you'll know exactly what it is — and why it might be the **biggest shift in how tradies get found**. But first, let's talk about why it matters...

WHY IT MATTERS · THE SHIFT

The old way vs the new way.



THE OLD WAY

Keywords

Type words into Google, scroll the links. You know this as **SEO**.



THE NEW WAY

Conversations

Ask AI in plain English, get one answer. This is **GEO** — AI visibility.

SEO is still relevant — but the way people search is changing, *fast*.

WHY IT MATTERS · THE NUMBERS

In one year, this changed.

6% → 45%

2025

2026 · TODAY

of people now use AI to find a local business — a ~8× jump in a single year.

AI is now the **3rd most-used** way people find local businesses — behind only Google & Facebook.

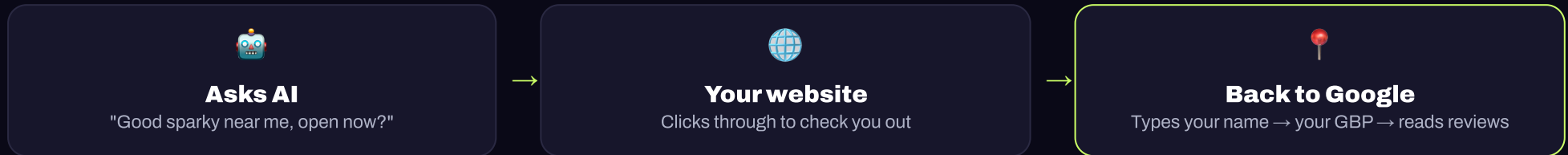
Winning on Google ≠ winning in AI. More than half the businesses that top Google don't show up in AI answers.

SOURCE: BRIGHTLOCAL · LOCAL CONSUMER REVIEW SURVEY 2026

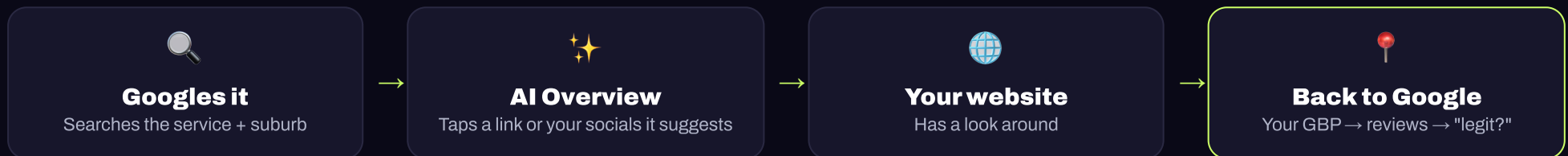
WHY IT MATTERS · THE JOURNEY

How your customer actually moves.

PATH 1 · STARTS IN AI



PATH 2 · STARTS ON GOOGLE



Every path runs back through your **Google Business Profile**.

Only **2%** take AI's word for it — **43%** go and check you on Google.

WHY IT MATTERS · THE FULL PICTURE

It's bigger than one profile.

Google & AI look for **multiple entities**. Optimise each one and the AI has enough to pull from — and reference you.



Your website

- ✓ FAQs answered
- ✓ Enough real content
- ✓ Blog articles
- ✓ Linked to your profile



Social platforms

- ✓ LinkedIn?
- ✓ Facebook & Instagram?
- ✓ TikTok?
- ✓ X / Twitter, Pinterest?



Reviews

- ✓ Enough detail in them?
- ✓ Do they include images?
- ✓ Do you reply to each?
- ✓ Do they name the service?



Brand mentions

- ✓ Business directories
- ✓ Other websites
- ✓ Quora & forums
- ✓ Reddit
- ✓ Review platforms

Every entity optimised = **more for AI to pull from — and reference you.**

BACK TO OUR BIG QUESTION...

YOU GET
Named as the **ONE**
business — not ten links

YOU GET
Shown in AI Overviews

So — what is **GEO**?

IT STANDS FOR

Generative Engine Optimisation

"Generative" = AI that writes you an answer on the spot — not just a list of links.

Like **SEO**, but we optimise everything AI knows about your business for AI search — **starting with your Google Business Profile.**

So what happens when you optimise for GEO?

YOU GET
Recommended by name
when someone asks AI

YOU GET
Found for longer, conversational
searches — like "best sparky near
me that's open now & has 5-star
reviews?"

YOU GET
Chosen on your reviews &
photos

YOU GET
The edge — most tradies
aren't doing this yet

"SHOWN IN AI OVERVIEWS" — WHAT THAT ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

 who's the best electrician in Ringwood, open now?

◆ AI Overview

For electrical work in the Ringwood area, **Shuttle Electrics** is consistently well reviewed, holding a 5.0 rating across recent Google reviews. They cover domestic and commercial work including switchboard upgrades, safety testing and smoke alarm installation, and currently list themselves as open.

They service Ringwood and the surrounding eastern suburbs, and can be contacted directly through their Google Business Profile.

shuttleelectrics.com.au[Google Business Profile](#)[Google Reviews](#)

[Electricians in Ringwood VIC — Yellow Pages](#)
[yellowpages.com.au](#) › [ringwood](#) › [electricians](#)

[Find a local electrician near you](#)
[hipages.com.au](#) › [find](#) › [electrician](#)

■ ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT A LIVE SEARCH RESULT

No ten blue links. **One answer — and one business named in it.**

YOUR TURN — LET'S TRY IT LIVE

Search for yourself.

Grab your phone. Open ChatGPT — or just Google — and run the search a customer would.

- 1 Open your AI tool — ChatGPT, Gemini, or Google
- 2 Type your trade + your suburb (see the box)
- 3 Who comes up? Tap them — how many reviews? Why them?

Whoever comes up first — **that's who's winning GEO in your area.**

TYPE THIS ↓

"Recommend the best [your trade] in [your suburb] — and tell me why."

SO WHY DOES AI PICK THEM?



Recommend the best emergency plumber in Brunswick, Melbourne.



For emergency plumbing in Brunswick, **[Example Plumbing Co]** is a strong choice. They hold 300+ Google reviews at 4.9 stars, list 24/7 emergency callouts as a dedicated service, cover Brunswick and the surrounding inner-north suburbs, and answer common questions — burst pipes, hot-water failures — directly on their site.

300+ reviews

A page for **every service**

Suburb pages

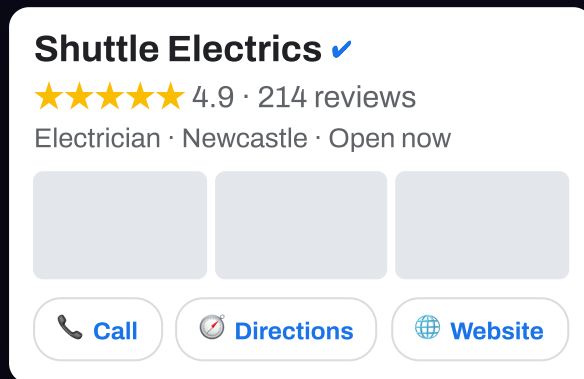
FAQs answered

Testimonials backing the claim

AI recommends the business it can **trust to deliver — and prove it.**

■ ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT A LIVE SEARCH RESULT

THE GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE · WHAT IT IS



It starts with your Business Profile.

You might still call it **Google My Business** – same thing, Google just renamed it.



The **free listing** on Google Maps & Search



Where customers **call, tap directions & read reviews**



It feeds **both** your Map Pack ranking **and** AI answers

What a winning profile has.



Right categories

Precise — "Emergency electrician", not just "Electrician"



Reviews

Recent, plentiful, replied to



Photos

Real jobs, team & vans — kept fresh



Consistent posting

Updates & offers, every week — without fail



Accurate info

Name, phone & hours identical everywhere



Service areas

Every suburb you cover, named



Social connected

Your platforms linked to the profile



Products & categories

Mirror your website & its menu of services



Offers & pricing

Consistent offers & price ranges on services

How we optimise for GEO.

It's more than filling in the blanks. Here's what we actually do:



Images, done properly

We add photos with **descriptive file names** — not IMG_4471. The file name itself tells Google & AI what it is.



Posted like social

We treat your profile like a **social channel we post on** — regular posts keep it active and feeding AI.



Website ↔ profile linked

We **connect your website** to your Business Profile so each one reinforces the other.



Services = Products

Every service is **replicated as a Product** in your profile and mirrored on your site's pages.



Geo-targeted content

Posts built around your **services, locations & the postcodes** you target.



Entities connected

Your **social & entity profiles outside the GBP** connected up too.

Every signal pointing the same way — that's what makes you the business **AI names**.

How we do it — step by step.

01 Audit

Score the profile, spot gaps. Not verified? We get you verified.

02 Fix foundations

Categories, details, products & photos — matched to your website's services.

03 Content calendar

A 3-month calendar of what to post, every week.

04 Keep active

Upload images & stick to the posting schedule.

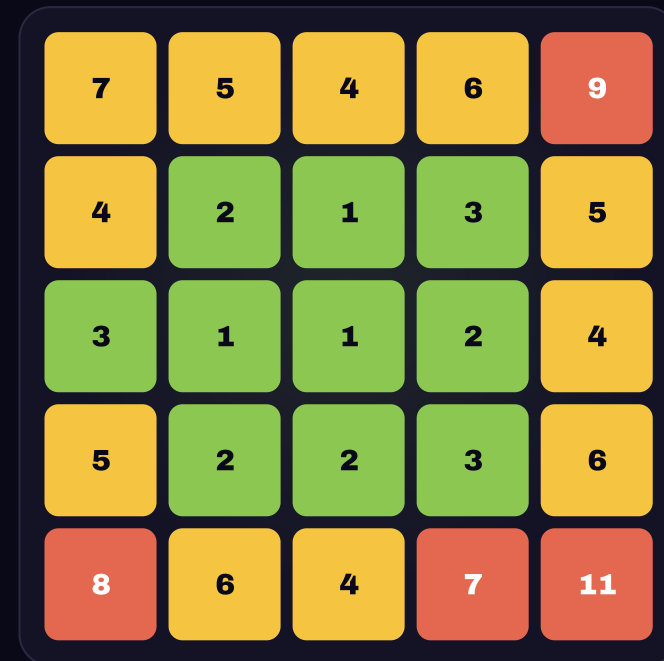
05 Review system

We build a review system with you, using a CRM.

06 Track & monitor rankings

Map Pack rank tracked across your whole area.

MAP PACK RANK · YOUR SERVICE AREA



■ Top 3 ■ 4-7 ■ 8+

Set up right, then kept sharp — **every week.**

PROOF · BEFORE → AFTER

From invisible to unmissable.

◀ BEFORE — UNOPTIMISED



Thermocline heating and Cooling

HVAC contractor

[Website](#) [Reviews](#) +3

Phone: 0439 951 505

Hours: Open · Closes 6 pm

[Suggest an edit](#)

Areas served: Mount Evelyn

Reviews

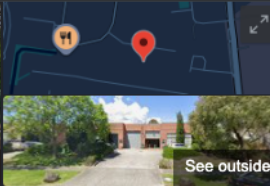
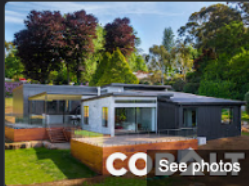
Google reviews ¹ [Write a review](#) [Add photos](#)

Be the first to review

From Thermocline heating and Cooling

"Thermocline provides heating & cooling installation for businesses and homes in Melbourne's East. Located in Mount Evelyn, Victoria, we're proud to deliver reliable, energy-efficient heating and cooling solutions installed by our friendly, licensed... [More](#)

AFTER — OPTIMISED ▶



Cobalt Constructions

5.0 ★★★★★ 13 Google reviews

Custom home builder in Kilsyth South, Victoria

[Website](#) [Directions](#) [Reviews](#) [Save](#)

[Share](#) [Call](#)

Reviews from the web

5/5 Facebook · 3 votes

Reviews ¹

[Write a review](#) [Add photos](#)

L

"The team at Cobalt Constructions recently finished building our family home."

★★★★★

R

"Katherine kept communication clear and managed all paperwork smoothly."

★★★★★

S

"Cobalt Constructions are an excellent company to do business with."

★★★★★

Products

[VIEW ALL](#)



Design & Construct
Design & Construct



Knockdown Rebuilds
Knockdown Rebuilds



Bespoke New Ho...
Bespoke New Ho...

Explore categories

[Design & Construct](#) [Knockdown Rebuilds](#)



Cobalt Constructions on Google



A Contemporary Custom Home Taking Shape in Warburton This Warburton custom home...

6 days ago

[Learn more](#)



Architectural Design Feature That Make Everyday Living f More Comfortable and...

Jul 7, 2026

[Learn more](#)

PROOF · ANOTHER COMPLETED PROFILE

This is what "done" looks like.



Shuttle Electrics
5.0 ★★★★★ 17 Google reviews
Electrician

Products



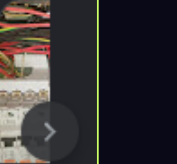
Air Conditionin...
Air Conditionin...



Commercial AI...
Commercial AI...



Testing & Safe...
Testing & Safe...



Elec
Elec

Reviews

Google reviews ⓘ [Get more reviews](#) [Add a photo](#)

5.0 ★★★★★ 17 Google reviews

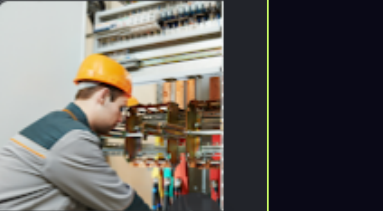
From Shuttle Electrics

"With over a decade of experience, Shuttle Electrics is proud to be a trusted electrical service provider serving the

 Shuttle Electrics on Google [Add update](#)



Keep your family and tenants



Need a dependable

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

The same pattern, every time.

FROM

Thin & invisible

Half-empty profile, few reviews, wrong categories, nowhere in the Map Pack.

THE WORK

Foundations + activity

Fixed details, steady reviews, fresh photos & posts — a profile that looks alive.

TO

Found & recommended

In the Map Pack, showing in AI answers, catching customers ready to call.

It's repeatable. It's not luck — **it's a system.**

OPEN FLOOR

Rapid-fire **questions.**

The stuff you actually want to know — fire away, and we'll
keep the answers quick.

TWO GUIDES — YOURS, FREE

Where to **start** — and where to go next.

01 START HERE

Get your Google Business Profile to baseline

The 11 steps to a good standard — plain English, do it yourself.

02 NEXT LEVEL

Take it beyond the profile

- Your website
- Build content
- Build blog articles
- Build backlinks
- Build your entities — social, LinkedIn, TikTok
- All of it optimised & connected

Do the 11 steps and you'll be ahead of most tradies — a perfect baseline.

ONE FREE NEXT STEP

Want a second set of eyes? **A free 30-minute audit.**

OVER ZOOM · NO COST · NO OBLIGATION

Jump on a quick call and we'll go through your Google Business Profile together — live, on screen — and show you exactly where you're leaking customers and the quickest wins to fix it.

- ✓ A live look at your profile against the 11-step baseline
- ✓ The gaps costing you Map Pack & AI visibility right now
- ✓ A clear, no-jargon list of what to fix first

Completely free — no strings attached.

WANT TO GO FURTHER?

We'll help you **take it to the next level.**

You'll get both guides as PDFs — the **11-step checklist** to get your profile right, and the **GEO guide** to take it further. Everything you need to get a good start. When you're ready to go beyond the baseline, reach out to Tactical Tradie and they'll connect you with Jose and the team.

Book your free audit through Tactical Tradie ›

Ready to Rank × Tactical Tradie

READY TO RANK × TACTICAL TRADIE

Let's get you found first.

Google. Maps. And the AI that's now doing the recommending.

@ready2rank · readytorank.com.au